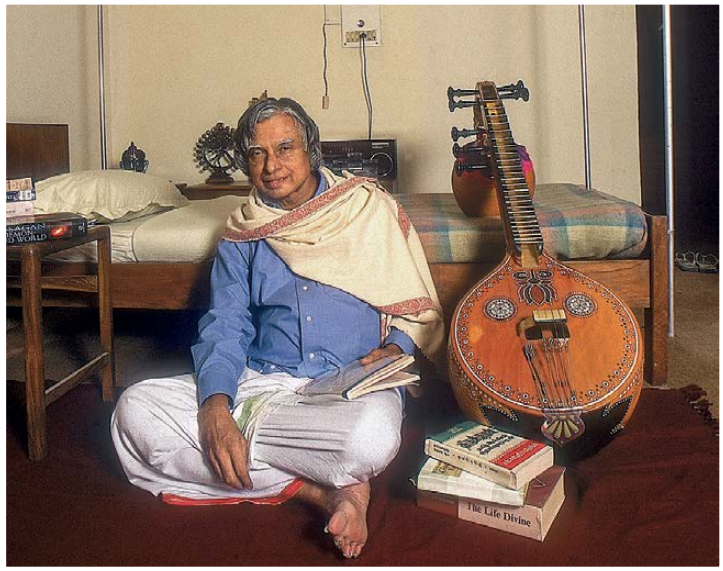
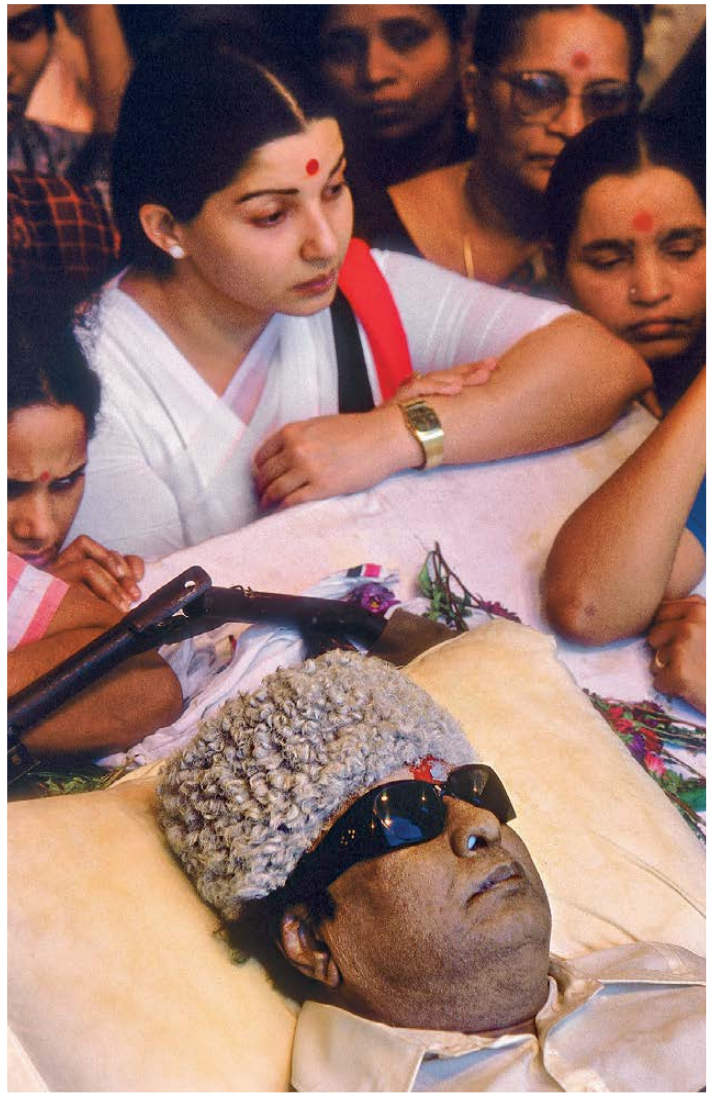




A.P.J. Abdul Kalam
December 19, 1997

Photograph by
BHAWAN SINGH

The bedroom in A.P.J. Abdul Kalam's Delhi residence was simply furnished, but the veena—and books on science, philosophy and literature—gave it a rich elegance and spoke much about the man. Kalam, who was chief of the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) when this photo was taken, later became one of India's most beloved presidents (2002-2007)



MGR and Jayalalithaa
December 25, 1987

Photograph by
PRAMOD PUSHKARNA

The death of M.G. Ramachandran marked the end of an era in Tamil Nadu politics. Standing beside his mortal remains is J. Jayalalithaa, then widely regarded as his political heir, at a moment steeped in grief, uncertainty and looming transition within the All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam